



FOR THE
FULL INTERVIEW

« The T20 World Cup will be the perfect platform to showcase our organisational capability in cricket »

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Two months after successfully hosting the Women's ODI World Cup, the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) is gearing up for another ICC event — the Men's T20 World Cup.

While the tournament will be played across five tried-and-tested venues in India, along with a phase in Sri Lanka, logistical challenges remain. However, BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia tells *Sportstar* that by hosting events throughout the year, the operations team has learned how to deliver successful tournaments.

As another ICC event beckons, how's the preparation going?

After the Women's ODI World Cup concluded on November 2, our team immediately had to be on its toes for the T20 World Cup, so everyone was busy. The best part [about the preparation] is that everything is sorted, as our team is very experienced and extremely professional in handling such [high-profile] events. The ICC is also

giving us full support. Its team has been in India for the last few weeks, working in tandem with us. The only challenge is that with Sri Lanka co-hosting, [proper] coordination is required, and that is happening in the right earnest with Jay Shah at the helm of the ICC, along with Sanjog (Gupta) as CEO of the ICC. Things are moving very quickly. Hemang Amin, the BCCI CEO, is also doing his job well. I am sure this will be a wonderful tournament without any hiccups.

Ahmedabad has already bagged the 2030 Commonwealth Games, and efforts are on to bring the 2036 Olympics to India as well. In that context, how important is the Men's T20 World Cup in showcasing India's administrative and organisational capability?

The 2023 Men's ODI World Cup was a wonderful experience, where all the venues operated at full capacity, with not a single logistical issue. New systems and periphery, upgraded infrastructure, and increased crowd involvement gave the BCCI the

confidence to host bigger events.

The T20 World Cup will be the perfect platform to showcase our organisational capability in cricket. Sports administrators are well-equipped and experienced to host the Commonwealth Games. If we are lucky to get the opportunity to host the 2036 Olympics, I am sure the Prime Minister's dream will be fulfilled.

In the Women's World Cup, relatively smaller venues were given the chance to host matches, but for the men's event, traditional centres have been picked. What's the reason?

There are two ways of looking at it. One is that we want to take cricket to every nook and corner of the country. While the bigger venues have hosted a lot of cricket over the years, the smaller venues are relatively new. All of them have come up in the last few years and have world-class infrastructure.

Right now, 30 international-standard stadiums in the country can host any form of